Terms and Conditions of the RAG.co Query Desk

> Fictional. Part of the RAG.co story in this app, not real terms, people or events.

Version 1.1, effective Tuesday 1 December 2026. Issued by RAG.co, Level 3, 12 Index Lane, Card Catalogue District.

1. Definitions

1.1. In these terms, **Question** means anything you ask the Query Desk, in words, whether at the counter or sent in.

1.2. **Card** means a single piece of text filed on a Shelf, small enough to be read on its own. A Card keeps its heading, and its page number if it came from a paged document.

1.3. **Shelf** means a group of Cards on one subject, kept together in the Archive.

1.4. **Citation** means a number in square brackets, such as [1], placed after a claim in an answer and pointing to the Card that supports it.

1.5. **We**, **us** and **RAG.co** mean the company at 12 Index Lane. **You** means the person asking.

2. Opening hours

2.1. The Query Desk opens whenever a Question arrives. There are no fixed opening hours.

2.2. After a quiet spell the building goes to sleep. When a Question arrives, it takes up to one minute to wake.

2.3. We do not charge for waiting time, and we do not count the minute against any limit in these terms.

2.4. If the building has not woken after five minutes, you may send the Question again.

3. Your question

3.1. A Question must be shorter than 1,000 characters, counting spaces.

3.2. A Question that is longer is not answered. We ask you to shorten it and send it again.

3.3. A Question may be about our Shelves or about your own papers (see clause 7), or both.

3.4. We answer in the language of the Question.

4. No-guessing guarantee

4.1. Every claim in an answer is pinned to a Card by a Citation.

4.2. A claim with no Citation is void. It is not our answer and you should not rely on it.

4.3. A Citation that points to a number that matches no Card is removed from the answer before you see it.

4.4. We use only the Cards we are shown. We do not add facts from memory.

4.5. If the Cards disagree, we say that they disagree and cite each side.

4.6. If the Cards answer only part of your Question, we answer that part and say clearly what is missing.

5. Nothing-found clause

5.1. If our Shelves do not cover your Question, we say so. The usual wording is “I can’t answer that from the available documents.”

5.2. In that case, no Citation is given, because there is nothing to cite.

5.3. We never borrow an answer from Guesswork & Co., the firm across Index Lane, or from any other source that answers without looking things up.

5.4. A nothing-found reply is a complete and correct answer under these terms. It is not a fault, and it is not a reason for a refund.

6. Selection

6.1. To answer a Question, we first pull up to 20 Cards from the Shelves that look like they may help.

6.2. We then read all 20 against your Question and keep the best 5.

6.3. At most 5 Cards are cited in any answer.

6.4. The Cards that were pulled but not kept are not cited and do not affect the answer.

6.5. If fewer than 5 Cards are useful, fewer are cited.

7. Your own papers

7.1. You may bring your own papers to the Mail Room.

7.2. Your papers are cut into Cards and kept in your own folder, which stays with you.

7.3. Your papers are never filed in the shared cabinet. Other members cannot search them or see them.

7.4. You may send up to 60 Cards from your folder with a single Question.

7.5. When you close your folder, your papers are gone. We keep no copy.

7.6. While we answer, part of your papers may be shown to the people who help us write the answer, such as our outside reading and writing suppliers. We tell you this because it is true.

8. Out-of-scope subjects

8.1. Some subjects are not on our Shelves and never will be. These include cooking recipes and football results.

8.2. Questions on these subjects get the nothing-found reply under clause 5.

8.3. This list may grow. Additions are decided under clause 10 and recorded in the minutes.

9. Liability

9.1. We take care to cite only what the Cards say. We do not promise that the Cards themselves are complete or up to date.

9.2. We are not liable for loss caused by relying on a Card that is out of date. Check the Citation.

9.3. We are liable for an answer that makes a claim with no Citation only to the extent of clause 4.2: the claim is void.

9.4. Nothing in these terms limits liability that cannot be limited by law.

9.5. We are not liable for the sign in the Query Desk, which says “Days since last hallucination: 0”, and which is a reminder, not a promise.

10. Changes to these terms

10.1. These terms are changed only at the monthly meeting.

10.2. Every change is recorded in the minutes, with the date of the meeting and the clause changed.

10.3. A change takes effect on the first day of the next month.

10.4. Version 1.1 added football results to the list in clause 8.1. It was decided at the meeting of 27 November 2026.

10.5. The current version is posted at the Query Desk.

11. How an answer is written

11.1. An answer is written in plain words, in short paragraphs of two or three sentences.

11.2. Citations appear in square brackets after the sentences they support, for example [1] or [1][2] if two Cards support the sentence.

11.3. You may open any Citation to see the Card it points to, including its heading and, where it has one, its page.

11.4. We do not mention the way the answer was prepared, only the Cards it came from.

12. Complaints

12.1. If you think an answer is wrong, bring the Citation to the counter. We will look at the Card again.

12.2. If the Card says something different from the answer, we correct the answer and note the correction on the Query Desk board.

12.3. If the Card agrees with the answer, the answer stands.

12.4. Complaints are reviewed by the office manager within 5 working days.

13. Contact

13.1. Come to Level 3, 12 Index Lane, in the Card Catalogue District. The district is fictional, and so is the address.

13.2. If the building is asleep, ring the bell no more than twice and wait up to one minute.